

FINAL REPORT



Fourth General Service Conference of A. A.



1954

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THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

The close of each General Service Conference leaves most members with a lingering impression of some dominant theme, or themes, by which the Conference can be identified and remembered. Beyond the talk, the actions and the decisions, each Conference is distinguished for its own particular personality, for the way in which it did things, as well as for things done themselves.

The sense of a Conference is not always found in the issues or problems that required most discussion. It is not always recorded in the "big" or bold decisions. Instead, it may be revealed fleetingly in some casual comment, some parenthetical phrase that revealed and expressed the essence of the Conference in a manner which all could recognize.

Members this year met in an atmosphere that differed in many respects from the climate of previous meetings. The Conference, now recognized as a vital factor in preservation of the Third Legacy, was no longer a novelty. The men and women who met this year knew from experience the time-consuming and specific responsibilities that must always be associated with this phase of A.A. service. As former Delegates, or through their activity as Area Committeemen, they were probably more familiar with the scope of Service Headquarters operations than any previous conferees. Without doubt, they also had greater appreciation of the needs those Headquarters services are designed to fulfill.

Meeting in this atmosphere, coping with a crowded agenda, what distinguishing mark has the 1954 meeting left on the pages of Conference history?

Perhaps there were two marks.

Perhaps the first dominant theme, never actually expressed in so many words, was the fact that the movement seemed to have achieved a larger measure of self-confidence in its ability to accept and direct the Third Legacy. Bill and Dr. Bob, the Trustees and the Service Headquarters staff, had anticipated that confidence. They had felt that the fellowship, now crossing the threshold of maturity, was abundantly endowed with collective wisdom, in matters both spiritual and material, to assure the survival of A.A.

But to many A.A.s themselves, in previous years, this concept had been totally new, totally untried. This year there was a new, more confident note in many of the discussions. As one delegate phrased it: "The movement is no longer afraid to accept its share of the great responsibilities it once never fully understood."

Perhaps the second mark of the 1954 Conference was linked, like a shadow, to the first one. For in expressing its self-confidence, the Conference again and again demonstrated its awareness that, in A.A., responsibility is always composed of two important elements: responsibility to respect local autonomy and responsibility to assure the survival of the movement itself.

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE (Continued)

The 1954 Conference was confronted with more momentous, potentially divisive, decisions than any previous Conference had faced. It never, however, lost sight of the fact that essentially local problems are the concern of local areas. It never lost sight of the fact that its responsibility was not to govern, not to legislate, but to serve as the vital link between the individual member and the essential worldwide services of the fellowship to which other individual members may also one day owe their sobriety.

Self-confidence and responsibility! If these were truly the marks of the 1954 Conference, perhaps they were most clearly entwined and revealed at that point of one of the tangled discussions when the delegates elected to take time out for a few moments of silent meditation and each member looked into his own heart---and beyond---for true guidance. For this self-confidence was not brash; it was prayerful. And this responsibility was not limited to considerations of the moment, but represented a search for great truths.

Only the future will determine whether the decisions made this year were great decisions. Beyond question, they were responsible ones. In many cases, as in previous years, there were important decisions not to do certain things. Even in such cases the intent behind the decision was keyed to the great affirmative of acting only in the light of collective certainty, not in the shadow of disturbing compromise.

If they indeed represented "the sense of the Conference," the twin themes of confidence and responsibility spell the promise of a truly servicefull future for the fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous.

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THE GREAT DEBATE AND THE FUTURE OF A.A.

Excerpts from Comments by Bill at Closing Session

This is the closing hour of the Conference, one of the greatest hours that I have ever lived because, I believe, it marks the date when this Society has really gone on its own, and will become forever saved from any or all power that may threaten it.

Each Conference has its own distinct personality and achievement. More than any other, this Conference, I believe, had confidence. More than any other, it envisioned its responsibility now and for all the time to come. Confidence and responsibility have been the keynotes.

As recently as six or eight years ago, my own confidence in our destiny was terribly shaken. Among us there had arisen a terrible risk. Like all of the risks and struggles in A.A., however, this was concerned with the universal question: "What is best for A.A.?" The debate was about whether or not we would have a Conference. Back in those days the Traditions had taken form and had just been put on paper, but there still remained this terrific question of how to guarantee our overall function, how to create a structure that could withstand power drivers and the ravages of time and of adverse circumstance.

So I took the problem to the Trustees of The Alcoholic Foundation, the board of A.A. members and friends of A.A. that we had put together in 1938. We were sitting then as an incorporated board, providing service that would enable this Society to hold together to carry its message; and we still assume the right to be the guarantors and guardians of its tradition and general welfare. We had aggregated a self-assumed authority, and quite properly during the infancy of the movement. We had aggregated the authority to print the literature, to help resolve group problems, to be answerable to the public, to administer your funds, to provide your mirror of A.A. life in a monthly magazine. All of this authority we had simply assumed and by common consent in 1945 the movement was only too glad to have us do this job.

But the day might come when a great blunder would be made; when there might be a great scandal, when there might be a great religious or political division. And the day might come when from sheer remoteness and lack of interest or understanding, the support of this overall function might melt away. Moreover, the movement, out in the group and area level, had begun to say that they wished to take their affairs into their own hands, even as men coming of age.

So the debate turned on how A.A. as a whole could take its affairs into its own hands and be secure. How could Service Headquarters and the Board of Trustees, custodians of the vital authority the movement had delegated, and with demonstrated capacity to perform movement-wide services---how could they be linked to the movement and to the world outside? When I began to appreciate how little real linkage there was, I got scared to death. I went to my friends the Trustees and said: "There has to be a hook-up. This movement has now grown to the point where there must be some means by which it can look after its own affairs if it wants to. And even if it doesn't want to, it is still entitled to a look."

THE GREAT DEBATE AND THE FUTURE OF A.A.
(Continued)

Well, my old friends said to me what many an old-time around A.A. still says: "Let's keep it simple." To me, the real issue was: should we keep it simple by getting you people in here to see that it lasted, or would we make it complicated by keeping it so simple that it would break apart. The result of this debate, which lasted until late 1950, was the Third Legacy Program, in which the General Service Conference is the vital force.

To overcome the objection that there would be terrible politics in the selection of Conference Delegates at the grass roots, we had to go in for a species of political invention. We had to eliminate hotly-contested elections that leave behind hostile minorities. And we had to do away with personal nominations from the floor. The final process did just that. It was the process that got you here feeling like servants, not senators---and without leaving much, if any, hostility behind you.

Then came another question: How would Delegates be related to the Board of Trustees who already had legal rights, who possessed responsibility for our public relations, who had title to our publications and who served as custodians of A.A. funds? Legally, what power could the Conference exercise over all those things? What influence could you have upon the selection of future A.A. Trustees themselves?

The answer is that, legally, the Conference could not take away the authority granted to the Trustees, if the Trustees chose to hold on to it. But, as you know, the Trustees have wisely consented to make themselves amenable to the desires of the Conference. They said, and rightly: "Let us keep the legal form of the thing; we need that to transact business. But let us, on any two-thirds vote of this Conference in which we also participate, be traditionally under a mandate from this Conference. Let us be part of this Conference, but a minority, and let us hereafter, when we name successors to A.A. Trustees, submit such names to a committee of the Conference. And when an out-of-town A.A. Trustee is sought, let us make appropriate inquiries within A.A. in the region under consideration."

And thus, in general principle, there came into being the structure of The Third Legacy. Today, in this last hour of the time of experiment, I share with you the promise of its certain success and am more moved than at almost any time in my A.A. life. The moment of the transfer of authority to serve, from us old timers to the movement, is at hand and will be certified, let us trust, in 1955.

We have had under construction all these nearly 20 years a way of life, which we might say is housed in the A.A. Cathedral of Spirit. Standing on its vast floor are 120,000 who stand in safety because the Twelve Steps, the principles on which we stand and by which we live, are inscribed thereon. And this floor is of ever-expanding, illimitable dimension. Four years ago in Cleveland, with the validation of our Twelve Traditions, we realized that we had placed 12 wonderful buttresses as insurance that the great walls of the Cathedral would not fall. Now we are at work on the final construction, the spire of our Cathedral of service, wherein shines the beacon light to those of us who are still in the dark. The work on the spire is not yet complete, but our confidence is that it will there shine throughout the world, until the most distant beachhead, for so long as God wants it.

THE LOST COMMANDMENT, THE DICTIONARY AND A.A.

Excerpt from Opening Talk by Bernard B. Smith, Chairman of the Board of Trustees

As the time of this fourth General Service Conference approached, I found myself thinking of many things--of those exciting, early struggling days when A.A. was taking form; of the many friendships that A.A. has made possible for me, a non-alcoholic; of the countless heartwarming experiences that have been mine within the fellowship of A.A.; of the wonder that in so short a time A.A. could have produced a General Service Conference with every section of the United States and Canada represented by its chosen delegates. More than anything else, perhaps, I thought of the miracle of timing in A.A., of the fact that things seem to get started in A.A. only when the time is ripe, of the vexations at things unaccountably delayed, and the later realization that they were delayed only because the time for doing them had not yet arrived.

And I thought of the Finger of God determining our course, and the words, "Finger of God," brought to mind the Ten Commandments. I found myself reading the Divine Law as though for the first time, with the heart of A.A. and the brain of the law, which is my profession. And I thought then that, while all remember, even if all do not observe, all of the "shalt nots" in these Commandments, few remember the one or two "shalts" of the Ten Commandments. One great "shalt" is the Commandment, "Six days shalt thou labor, and the seventh day, rest."

The "Ten Commandments" is a single instrument, not ten separate commandments. The effect of the loss of this Commandment of affirmative action on all the negative "shalt not" Commandments in the Divine Law cannot, therefore, be overlooked.

In the period of life when the Ten Commandments were written...men worked in the fields as I did when I was a boy, from dawn to dusk, and if the seventh day was spent at rest, the "shalt nots" or prohibitory Commandments were not difficult to follow. "Lead us not into temptation" -- and "Six days shalt thou labor and the seventh day, rest" -- was one of God's ways of not leading us into temptation. But by society's unilateral abrogation of this divine Commandment, the "shalt nots" now become difficult to observe. And so, with the 40-hour, five-day week, we developed something that the Ten Commandments did not contemplate--a leisure-time society.

I believe that our Twelve Steps were spiritually conceived to meet the challenge of this reality--the reality of the development of a leisure-class society to whom the socially accepted ideals had become grossly materialistic. I like to think that our Twelve Steps--twelve "shoulds" and not "shalls"--are a bridge in the gaping gulf in the Divine Law caused by the lost commandment.

Recently, I looked up the definition of "happiness" in my new, unabridged dictionary. To my surprise, the first definition there listed is "good luck, good fortune, prosperity." This materialistic definition is manifestly the antitheses of the kind of happiness that we in A.A. possess. The second definition in that dictionary, however, I found directly applicable to the kind of happiness we in A.A. believe we can maintain through living by the philosophy of A.A.'s Twelve Steps... This definition reads: "A state of well-being characterized by relative permanence, by dominantly agreeable emotion, ranging in value from mere content to positive felicity, and by a natural desire for its continuation."

THE LOST COMMANDMENT, THE DICTIONARY AND A.A.
(Continued)

It is measured in terms of this definition that I believe that those who live by the principles of A.A. achieve a higher measure of happiness than any class or group of people to which I, as an individual, have ever been exposed. I thought a good deal about this definition. I knew that the definitions contained in a dictionary follow current socially accepted usage and I was disturbed by the fact that the first definition of happiness should be defined today as "good luck, good fortune, prosperity." So I examined a number of dictionaries published in the 1890's, and I found that the word "prosperity" appeared in none of these dictionaries under the definition of "happiness." I then happened upon a standard dictionary published in 1927. By this time, the definition "good luck, good fortune, prosperity" not only appeared, but had reached second place. By 1943 it had reached first place, supplanting that definition of happiness by which we in A.A. prefer to be counted, and a totally material conception of happiness now held undisputed sway over modern society.

Our Twelve Steps, therefore, judged by the socially accepted standards of happiness of this age, are steps backward--yes, backward into the universal heart of men, back into the spirit of man. I will believe that the world has moved forward when our dictionaries are revised backward.

Recently I was flying over the deserts of our great Southwest. Here and there, almost out of nowhere, were tiny patches of lush green growth, surrounded by great expanses of brown, lifeless desert. I thought of the great springs of water lying under this desert expanse which, if tapped, would cause the entire desert to flower. And I thought, God provides the water but we have to dig the wells. Those green, lush patches, I likened to our groups, where, with the faith derived from our Twelve Steps, we dug the wells that caused a patch in the desert of life to flower. And I thought how we learned that we alone could not transform the desert in which we lived, we could not dig that well alone. For in A.A. the whole is truly greater than the sum of all its parts. The infusing power of the group, of our fellowship, draws something more out of each of us than any of us by himself can supply, and each of us in turn draws out of the spiritual reservoir of our fellowship the added courage and will which makes each of us the stronger, and our fellowship the greater.

I thought then of our General Service Conference, which provides channels between the wells of each group so none can go dry, of our general services that shore up the channels and keep them in repair and extend them as new A.A. oases are formed...

Tonight we convene the last of our trial Conferences. We must now decide whether the Third Legacy is something we want to accept. I should be less than forthright if I did not express my views. I believe that the General Service Conference is and must be a permanent part of the structure of Alcoholics Anonymous. I say that not only because of what the fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous means to us, but because of what the fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous can mean to the future of human society. For our fellowship is an island of hope for the life of the spirit, a kind of fellowship to which in time man, beset by the materialism and commercialism of this electronic age, must one day turn to survive.

THE LOST COMMANDMENT, THE DICTIONARY AND A.A.
(Continued)

We owe an obligation to society to insure that this ideal fellowship which we possess survives, that this flame of faith, this beacon light of hope for the world, must never be extinguished.

We may not need a General Service Conference to insure our own recovery. We do need it to insure the recovery of the alcoholic who still stumbles in the darkness one short block from this room. We need it to insure the recovery of a child being born tonight, destined to alcoholism. We need it to provide, in keeping with our Twelfth Step, a permanent haven for all alcoholics who, in the ages ahead, can find in A.A. that rebirth which brought us back to life. We need it because we, more than all others, are conscious of the devastating effect of the human urge for power and prestige which we must insure can never invade A.A. We need it to insure A.A. against government, while insulating it against anarchy; we need it to protect A.A. against disintegration while preventing over-integration. We need it so that Alcoholics Anonymous; and Alcoholics Anonymous alone, is the ultimate depository of its Twelve Steps, its Twelve Traditions and all of its services. We need it to insure that changes within A.A. come only as a response to the needs and the wants of all A.A., and not of any few. We need it to insure that the doors of the halls of A.A. never have locks on them so that all people for all time that have an alcoholic problem may enter these halls unasked and feel welcome. We need it to insure that Alcoholics Anonymous never asks of anyone who needs us what his or her race is, what his or her creed is, what his or her social position is.

We need it because, in the words of Pope Pius XII, "Every people and every race which has been formed on earth today has an equal right to say, 'Our Father, Who art in Heaven.'"

(Note: The full text of Mr. Smith's address appears in the June, 1954 issue of The A. A. Grapevine).

SUMMARY OF PREVIOUS CONFERENCE ACTIVITY

The six basic reasons underlying the co-founders' 1950 proposal for a General Service Conference were reviewed by Conference Secretary Helen B. in a comprehensive summary of Conference history to date. They were:

1. Realization that Dr. Bob and Bill "could not last forever."
2. The fact that the Trustees were generally unknown to the movement.
3. Recognition that the Trustees would need future guidance from the movement itself.
4. Appreciation that A.A. was "growing up" and was able to assume rightful responsibility for its Headquarters and services.
5. The importance of bringing the Trustees into closer contact with the movement.
6. The need to be as completely prepared as possible to face some potentially grave crisis with action in the best interest of all A.A.s.

Major developments at each of the three previous Conferences were outlined. It was recalled, for example, that the first Conference, in 1951, representing only half of the Conference territories, had wisely deferred making a number of decisions until full representation would be on hand the following year. The 1951 sessions were notable for providing patterns for conducting future meetings, particularly in the matter of devising simple means of selecting Conference committees and in developing Conference Advisory Actions for the information and guidance of the Trustees.

In 1952, with full representation, the Conference reviewed and considered a number of policy problems affecting the movement as a whole and initiated a planned program of Conference-approved literature service.

The 1953 Conference, emphasizing "maturity," marked a further step toward full participation by the delegates in all matters of general interest. Special provision was made for full consideration of questions, comments and criticisms from A.A. areas. Nearly 40 topics were placed on the agenda anonymously, through the device of a convenient question box.

It was pointed out that this year's Conference represented a further extension of the "full-participation" policy, since nine policy matters had been submitted to the movement for discussion prior to the meeting and a full Conference session had been set aside "for Delegates only."

Experience of the past three Conferences has demonstrated, the Secretary said, that "the Conference truly is not a governing or legislative body. Instead it is a service group which in its actions, or even lack of action, faithfully reflects the collective conscience of the movement itself."

HIGHLIGHTS OF FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

(Detailed financial statements of A.A.'s three service organizations are included in Appendix II of this report. Significant features of the three statements are summarized below).

THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC.: The General Fund balance was improved by \$33,000, due to increased dividends from A.A. Publishing, Inc.

Contributions received and credited to the Group Contribution Fund increased from \$106,195 in 1952 to \$113,057, but higher expenses of the General Service Headquarters left a small balance of \$193 to reduce the deficit in this Fund. A payment of \$4,000 was made from this Fund on account of prior years' advances by the General Fund, leaving an unpaid balance of \$20,000.

Revenues of the 1953 Conference failed to meet expenses by \$8.675, and this deficit was met by a grant of \$8,621 from the General Fund and by a reduction of \$54 in the balance of the General Service Conference Fund.

A.A. PUBLISHING, INC.: Net assets increased by \$9,100 at the end of 1953, and were invested in accounts receivable and inventories. Book sales advanced from \$67,600 in 1952 to \$119,000 in 1953, with the increase largely accounted for by sales of "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions." Sales of pamphlets increased almost 50 per cent.

The total cost of operating the General Service Office increased from \$102,800 to \$140,050 and the method of allocating this cost between A.A. Publishing, Inc. and the Group Contribution Fund was adjusted so that A.A. Publishing, Inc. now bears a greater portion of the cost. Net income for the year increased from \$33,900 to \$59,100, of which \$50,000 was paid in dividends to the General Fund.

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.: Net income for the calendar year 1953 was \$4,983, as compared with \$5,041 in the preceding year. This reduced the deficit to \$18,986 at the year end. Further progress was also made in increasing the net quick assets to an amount equal to the unearned subscription income.

GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS OPERATIONS

Orders for books and pamphlets distributed by General Service Headquarters increased by more than a third during the past year, Hank G., General Service Manager, declared in his operations report to the Delegates, which also outlined certain policy problems covered in other sections of this Report.

The full scope of the voluminous detail underlying Headquarters services is suggested by the following figures:

1. Incoming mail totaled 34,000 separate pieces (inquiries, group communications, orders contributions etc.
2. Including the monthly bulletins, more than 120,000 outgoing pieces of mail cleared through Headquarters.
3. 10,264 orders for books and pamphlets were processed during 1953, compared with 7,675 the previous year.
4. Actual packages wrapped and sent totalled 16,718. (Many orders are shipped as two or more packages to comply with Parcel Post requirements). These packages contained:
 - a. 23,296 A.A. books
 - b. 29,567 copies of "The Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions"
 - c. 547,000 pamphlets
 - d. 243 sets of records
 - e. 157,000 wallet cards
5. The Accounting Department handled 4,596 remittances for the Group Contribution Fund, 1,117 for the Conference Fund and more than 10,000 covering orders shipped.

As a service to local and regional groups of A.A.s, members of the General Service Staff accepted invitations to attend 43 conventions, meetings and banquets in the following States and Provinces in the past year: North Carolina, Tennessee, Massachusetts, Florida, Michigan, Oklahoma, Connecticut, Virginia, District of Columbia, South Carolina, Illinois, New Jersey, Ohio, Vermont, Pennsylvania, New York, Kentucky, West Virginia, Mississippi, New Hampshire, Quebec (Montreal) and British Columbia (Vancouver).

Physical improvements, designed to increase the speed and efficiency of service to the groups, included establishment of separate shipping quarters, installation of an Addressograph system and modernization of office quarters. Favorable leases on both the shipping and office locations have been negotiated until 1958.

Between quarterly meetings of the Board of Trustees, Headquarters operations are supervised by seven persons who act as the General Service Committee on policy matters and as Directors of A.A. Publishing, Inc. on business affairs. This group includes three Trustees (one non-alcoholic), the Grapevine editor, a local A.A. with substantial group and Intergroup experience, the senior staff member in the Headquarters office and the General Service Manager.

THE LITERATURE PROGRAM

The literature program represents a careful, time-consuming, effort to reflect the needs and opinions of all sections of A.A., Ralph B., special consultant, emphasized in his report. Fifteen new major items have been developed since the program was adopted by the General Service Conference in 1952, he declared.

Procedures for developing literature were outlined as follows:

"First, no item is undertaken unless there is a definite, expressed, need for it. If the need is apparent, the general outlines are discussed with Headquarters people who are in touch with A.A. sentiment worldwide and with Bill. Then a draft is prepared and circulated to six to ten people, sometimes more. Their comments are discussed, analyzed and reconciled and a second draft is prepared. This draft is then circulated to the Trustees and to other A.A.'s throughout the country. The comments and suggestions of these people, representing a reliable cross-section of A.A. are incorporated into the final draft that goes to the printer. The important thing is that every effort is made to obtain and incorporate the widest possible range of A.A. thinking and experience in every item of literature. This is possible and practical only because Service Headquarters is literally both a store house and clearinghouse of total A.A. experience, with direct access of changing currents in A.A. development throughout the world."

The following distribution of literature was reported for the twelve months ending March 31st, 1954.

THIS IS A.A.	85,600	A.A. TRADITION	23,745
YOUNG PEOPLE & A.A. (New, Oct.)	18,139	THE ALCOHOLIC EMPLOYEE	21,162
44 QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS . . .	78,320	ABOUT THE ALCOHOLIC HUSBAND (Dis) . .	30,688
MEDICINE LOOKS AT A.A.	36,940	THE ALCOHOLIC HUSBAND	8,401
SATURDAY EVENING POST REPRINT	36,607	THE ALCOHOLIC WIFE (New-March) . . .	3,178
SOCIETY OF A.A.	37,600	SPONSORSHIP (New, April '53)	36,423
SEDATIVES & THE ALCOHOLIC. . .	24,872	THIRD LEGACY PAMPHLET	5,747
FORTUNE REPRINT	32,509	YOUR GENERAL SERVICE (New-Apr. '53).	35,522
A.A. FOR THE WOMAN	31,703		

Distribution of ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, The Big Book, totalled 23,296. Bill's new book, THE TWELVE STEPS AND TWELVE TRADITIONS, released last May, has resulted in orders for 29,567 copies to date.

During the year, 180 sets of recordings were sold and 63 single records of talks were distributed.

Revision of the pamphlet, MEDICINE LOOKS AT A.A., is currently underway, it was reported. Second and third editions of a number of the new pamphlets were also issued during the year.

PUBLIC RELATIONS POLICY AND PRACTICE

The A.A. public relations Tradition of "attraction, not promotion" is the keynote of all General Service Headquarters service in this field, Marian M. of the Headquarters staff reported. Nearly all of these services can be classified under three headings:

1. "Preventive" Public Relations. An example of this during 1953 was the staff's work with the author and publisher of a manuscript in which the A.A. Tradition of anonymity was seriously involved. As a result, 60 pages dealing with A.A. were re-written and the published version contains no direct reference to A.A.

In another instance, a national television magazine said that A.A. had sanctioned a telecast that violated the anonymity Tradition. Following correspondence with the magazine, a statement setting forth A.A.'s basic position on anonymity was published in a following edition.

In all cases of this type, the objective is to prevent the spread of misinformation regarding the A.A. program and the way in which it works.

2. Assistance to Writers and Editors: A number of manuscripts are submitted voluntarily to Headquarters for checking of factual references to A.A. A notable example of this type of help involved work with a staff writer of the New York Daily News, which has the largest circulation of any paper published in North America. The four articles resulted in unprecedented number of inquiries being directed to the New York Intergroup Office, the referral medium specified by Headquarters.
3. Special Projects: During 1953, these included such diverse activities as cooperation with the Minister of Justice of Venezuela, assistance to the office of the Police Commissioner of New York City, and participation in a meeting of the National Council of one of the major religious denominations (in accordance with A.A. policy of cooperation but non-affiliation with other agencies in the field of alcoholism).

Of the 1,169 inquiries received, 60 per cent were from members of the clergy, the medical profession, students and representatives of industry. The remaining 40 per cent came from relatives and friends of alcoholics and from alcoholics themselves. Each inquiry receives an appropriate answer and one or more pamphlets describing general and specific features of the A.A. program. Wherever possible, correspondents are referred to local sources of information.

Of particular interest to women alcoholics will be the fact that permission was obtained to reprint the fine article, "A Letter to a Woman Alcoholic," by Margaret Lee Runbeck, that appeared in the March, 1954 "Good Housekeeping."

SERVICE HEADQUARTERS AND THE GROUPS

Headquarters service to the groups and to alcoholics who turn to the Foundation for help depends to a large degree on the accuracy of its group records, Lib S. of the Headquarters staff pointed out in a special report on Group Relations.

The magnitude of the job of keeping records up-to-date is suggested by the following statistical summary covering the 12 months ending March 31, 1954.

1. 435 new groups were registered and "processed." Each group received a complimentary supply of literature, a copy of the "Handbook and Directory" and was added to the active mailing list. Ten distinct clerical operations are required each time a new group is registered.
2. 234 groups were removed from the active registration list, involving five clerical operations per group.

During the year, about 4,800 other changes were necessary as a result of groups adopting new mailing addresses, rotating secretaries and treasurers, and changing the time, day and place of meetings. A minimum of three clerical operations is required in each instance.

The above does not include the many details involved in producing the annual Directory of Groups, which is a major responsibility of the Group Relations personnel.

As the clearing house of accumulated A.A. experience worldwide, General Service Headquarters receives many inquiries each year from groups with specific problems; for example:

How do you determine what the numerical membership of a group really is?
How should anonymity be safeguarded on radio and television programs?
How do groups budget expenses?
Is it permissible to pay travelling expenses for A.A. speakers?

All inquiries are answered exclusively in terms of the experience of other groups that have faced and handled the same, or similar, problems.

The problem of maintaining effective contact with the groups is unending, and not always completely successful. Experience shows the need for plans and procedures "that will really link the groups to General Service Headquarters. 'Group relations' could then mean not only relating Headquarters services to each A.A. group, but relating groups to each other and to the fellowship of A.A. as a whole."

FOREIGN GROUPS AND INTERNATIONALISTS

The picture of A.A. outside the United States and Canada grows brighter every year, Ann M. of the Headquarters staff reported. Foreign groups now number 354 in 58 countries and have an approximate membership of 9,360, an increase of about 2,000 during the past year. Following are highlights of the report of A.A. worldwide:

SCANDINAVIA (Sweden, Norway, Finland, Germany) -- Approximately 3,500 members in this area. Because of special concept of alcoholism as a public health problem, State aid has become a factor in the A.A. program. This deviation from Tradition is opposed by a number of groups and individuals. "Antabuse" is accepted part of program in three countries. In Norway, one translation of the Twelve Steps omits reference to God. It is hoped that new translations of A.A. material, prepared through Headquarters here, will help to reaffirm importance of the spiritual side of the program in areas where it is now neglected.

GERMANY -- Three groups last year; approximately 20 today, comprising mostly Armed Forces personnel. One group of German nationals in Munich. German translation of text portion of Big Book and two pamphlets in German now available.

FRANCE -- Groups in Paris, Metz and Verdun. Mostly Armed Forces personnel but Paris group has several Frenchmen. French and German groups "exchange" meetings.

NETHERLANDS -- Four or five groups. Newsletter now being circulated among members by former Internationalist now living in Rotterdam. Translations under way.

BRITISH ISLES -- A.A. now firmly established, with greater medical and public understanding. Members from Great Britain, Ireland, Wales, Scotland meeting more frequently to consider common problems. Publishing house has been established in London to handle literature for countries in sterling area, thus overcoming previous obstacle to importation of material from U. S.

AUSTRALIA AND NEW ZEALAND -- Growth continues, new Central Offices set up in Brisbane, Adelaide and Melbourne in addition to A.A. Sydney Services Council. Newsletter, "The A.A. Reviver," major factor in unifying A.A. activities.

AFRICA -- About 35 groups with 1,140 members. (Capetown, Durban, Johannesburg).

ISRAEL -- First group recently established, now has about eight members.

JAPAN -- One (American) group in Tokyo. Japanese have their own version, but it differs so widely from Traditional A.A. that it is not considered a group.

SOUTH AND CENTRAL AMERICA -- Combined membership of about 375. Fifteen groups in Brazil, members in British Honduras, Costa Rica, Cuba, Nicaragua, Guatemala, Colombia, Ecuador, Peru and Venezuela.

INTERNATIONALISTS (Seamen's Correspondence Group) -- Now comprises 98 members.

INSTITUTIONAL GROUPS (PRISONS AND HOSPITALS)

Prison groups have increased from 176 to 234 during the past year and hospital groups have increased from 101 to 154, Eve L. of the Headquarters staff declared in her report. Prison group membership now totals more than 12,000, an increase of 3,000 over a year ago.

Service to institutional groups is keyed largely to helping members exchange and share their special A.A. experience.

1. Exchange Bulletins for both the prison and hospital groups are prepared and distributed periodically, to both groups and Institution Committees on the "outside."
2. Hospital and prison lists are compiled annually. These show publications issued by various groups, list special tape recordings that are available from groups and outline the restrictions and privileges covering correspondence.
3. Each new prison group receives special informational material, including quotations from leading penologists.
4. Last Summer a special "Literature Package" was made available for purchase by "outside" groups who wished to support institutional programs. (\$4 worth of literature for \$3, or \$6.50 for \$5, including the Grapevine for one year.) 300 orders received in first month.

A notable development of the past year was the recommendation by the Texas Prison Board that A.A. become an integral factor in the rehabilitation programs of the Board's 14 units. Five groups are now operating within the Texas System.

New statewide Institution Committees or Fellowships were developed with A.A. help in Ohio, Oregon, Washington, Indiana, Arkansas during the past year. In Colorado A.A. is cooperating with a State-sponsored program.

Is this work productive? One two-year-old prison group, with 103 members, reports that 64 out of 73 released members are making good on the outside. One of the largest groups reports that only 10 per cent of 465 paroled or discharged members have been returned to prison. In a smaller group, only 3 out of 61 members have come back as parole violators.

Success and growth of institutional groups depend on two vital factors: (1) The in-patient or inmate group is more successful if it can function as nearly as possible along traditional lines, (2) Ultimate success for the individual member is likely to be in direct ratio to the support the institutional group receives from A.A. itself; the cooperation of outside groups is crucial.

To quote a bulletin issued by groups in a Canadian city: "As A.A. continues to find wider acceptance in the prisons and is made available to more and more alcoholic inmates who want it, the challenge to A.A. members on the outside is thrown into sharp focus. There is a tremendous amount of work that can be done in the co-ordination of the A.A. prison program and it is going to take a lot of unselfish effort to meet the challenge."

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE

With June, 1954 marking the anniversary of ten years' continuous publication, the record shows that A.A.s have really adopted and supported The Grapevine as their international monthly journal. The continuing increase in contributions of articles and illustrations has resulted in greater reader interest and response by mail. Circulation growth has been relatively slight in comparison with its potential. And for the third year in a row, the publication has operated in the black. Continued and increasing support of the Delegates and all other A.A.s in building circulation in the coming year would make it possible for The Grapevine to greatly accelerate the reduction of its \$17,000 deficit.

Editorially, it has been a year in which the following happened:

- Increased flow of articles and letters provided a better selection, many of good stature, from A.A.s of every state and province and many foreign countries.
- More volunteers, writers and artists, have improved the content by editing and illustrating articles which might not otherwise have passed muster.
- Generous moral support from Bill W. and the initiation of a series by him of "Fragments of History" (two published thus far) has helped in maintaining a high standard of material of movement-wide importance.
- The new "Closed Meeting Department" has begun to get readers' contributions, and "Across the Editor's Desk," replacing the more formal "Editorial," brings readers our handshake and a glimpse of our daily happenings.
- A questionnaire seeking readers' opinions of the magazine's editorial content is being circulated.
- Sig H. retired as Editor in January and suggested Sig S. as his replacement. Sid A. took on the latter's responsibilities on business management and circulation.
- Last, but perhaps closest to our correspondents and visitors, has been the new help from Sarah Thompson in promptly acknowledging all mail and greeting callers.

<u>Circulation</u>	<u>Number of copies</u>		<u>Increase in</u>
March Circulation	1954	1953	1954
Individual subscribers	16,227	15,832	395
Group sales			
ordered monthly	10,112*	9,192	920*
prepaid yearly	<u>3,164</u>	<u>3,134</u>	<u>480</u>
TOTAL CIRCULATION	29,953	28,158	
Increase March, 1954 over 1953			1,795 copies
*Increase of 500 over February, 1954			

The renewal rate of subscriptions is 66% as compared with 58% last year and 64% two years ago. Of the 16,000 subscribers, 70% or 11,000 have been steady readers for more than two years.

The magazine's circulation could be increased greatly, and very profitably, among 4,000 of the groups which do not order copies for sale at meetings.

Financially, operations were in the black for the third year after a deficit of \$28,000 had accumulated in the preceding years.

REPORT OF THE BOARD OF TRUSTEES

Following are highlights of actions taken and decisions made at the four quarterly meetings of the Board of Trustees of The Alcoholic Foundation during the past year, as reported by Mr. Bernard B. Smith, Chairman:

1. Recorded these changes in A.A. personnel:
Cliff Walker replaced Jerry McComber, deceased
Daniel Hennessy replaced Hank Grieme, resigned
Sigurd Sandmore replaced Tom Yutzy, term expired
Seegar Heavilin nominated to replace Jonas Andersen,
term expired, at April, 1954 Board meeting.
2. Engaged Hank Grieme as a paid staff member, on a part-time basis, as General Service Manager, acting as President of A.A. Publishing, Inc. and as Chairman of the General Service Committee. In line with the principle that no member of the Board of Trustees be salaried by a Headquarters service agency, he had previously resigned as a member of the Board.
3. Reviewed and evaluated various proposed changes in name of the Foundation and approved one proposal for submission to the Conference.
4. Reviewed and revised the basis for allocating General Service Headquarters expenses, the new formula being keyed to experience in recent operations.
5. Granted 500 copies of the Big Book to the "Pre-Foundation Committee" in the United Kingdom and Ireland, making a total of 2,000 copies granted to date, pending arrangements for publication of a separate edition in London.
6. Authorized foreign language areas to translate the Big Book and distribute mimeographed copies, but reserved publication and other rights.
7. Decided not to accept a royalty of \$.25 per copy on sales of a book on The Twelve Steps, which had been offered by the publishers.
8. Agreed that Foundation Funds on deposit in savings banks should be, and are, designated as "Reserve Funds."
9. Established a plan whereby, following each quarterly meeting, the Chairman will submit a report on the activities of both the Board and General Service Headquarters for the preceding three months. Problems on which a cross-section of movement opinion is desired will also be submitted to Delegates and Committeemen at the same time, using the method employed for transmitting the nine proposals sent prior to this Conference.
10. Approved a proposal that all Trustees in office at the time of the first Conference (1951) and all who serve thereafter, be invited to attend all Conferences, without vote, and at their own expense.

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1. HANDLING OF UNUSUAL BEQUEST
 2. CHANGE IN FOUNDATION NAME
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The Chairman presented for the consideration of the Conference, and for its Advisory Action, the situation created by the recent bequest to The Foundation of certain Texas property representing an estimated valuation of approximately \$17,000. It was explained that the terms of this particular legacy were such that the traditional statement to the executors of the estate, reciting A.A.'s policy of not accepting such bequests, was not pertinent and that the property had actually been conveyed as an asset of the Foundation.

The problem, the Chairman explained, was how to dispose of the bequest in accordance with A.A.'s long-standing policy of declining such gifts. It was also noted that all the other beneficiaries of the deceased A.A. were charitable institutions.

Discussion disclosed a variety of viewpoints and opinions, none of them contrary to the basic A.A. Tradition of declining gifts of this type. After full consideration of the problem, it was moved, seconded and approved unanimously: "That the Trustees be instructed to execute an appropriate instrument transferring the interest acquired by A.A. under this will proportionately to the other beneficiaries named by the deceased person."

The 1953 Conference had referred back to the Trustees responsibility for reviewing and suggesting changes in the name of The Alcoholic Foundation that would more accurately and clearly reflect the actual functions of that agency.

The Chairman reported that the Trustees were unanimous in submitting for Conference consideration a proposal to change the name of The Foundation to THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.

After brief discussion, a motion to this effect was adopted unanimously.

On the advice of the Chairman, as a legal counsel, the following motion was also adopted unanimously: "That The Alcoholic Foundation be authorized, in its discretion to transfer all of its assets, subject to all of its liabilities, to a corporation to be formed by the existing Trustees to be known as The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.; that the existing Trustees of the Foundation be asked to serve as Trustees and adopt by-laws for such corporation, and that The Alcoholic Foundation be continued as a corporate entity to protect the name, and that The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. be authorized to devote such funds as may be necessary to pay any taxes or other expenses to maintain the corporate existence of The Alcoholic Foundation, and that the Trustees be further authorized, in their discretion if they deem it advisable, to change the name of The Alcoholic Foundation to the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. and simultaneously organize a new corporation under the name of The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.

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3. DISCONTINUANCE OF DISCOUNTS ON BOOKS SOLD TO GROUPS
 4. ABOLITION OF GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE FUND (TABLED)
 5. FIFTH ANNUAL CONFERENCE AND 20TH ANNIVERSARY CONVENTION
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At an early session of the Conference, the possibility of revising the discount structure in sales of books to the groups was discussed at length. Underlying the discussion was the search for a means of developing a prudent reserve to assure continuity of basic Headquarters services in the event of a depression or recession.

No definite agreement was reached at this first session and the matter was referred for discussion at the closed session of Area delegates. At this later session, it was overwhelmingly agreed that discounts on books sold to groups should be discontinued entirely and this action was later confirmed by the full Conference. It was also agreed that the change should be effective July 1, 1954, and that the groups should be notified as soon as possible. It was further confirmed that the discounts should be restored when the Foundation Reserve Fund reached \$300,000 barring unforeseen emergencies.

The Conference reviewed at length the proposal that "The Special annual appeal to the groups for funds to underwrite the General Service Conference should be discontinued and the cost of the Conference should be added to the cost of General Service Headquarters."

Impressive differences of opinion emerged during the discussion and, in the Conference tradition of "seeking not compromise but certainty," the matter was referred to the following Special Committee on the Conference Fund: Crossland, (South Carolina), Perry (Vermont), Neufeld, (Wis.), Russell, (Kan.), Moncrief (Georgia), and Wallace, (Maritimes). The Conference Secretary will serve as a member of the Committee, as a duly qualified member of the Conference. (In this connection, Bill restated the fact that Trustees, Headquarters Staff people and, in fact, he himself, were qualified members of the Conference, as well as those elected in the various areas.) The Fund matter will be placed on the '55 Conference agenda.

In a spirit of basic A.A. humility, members of the Conference agreed that there was no need for Delegates who had already completed their period of service to return as members of an enlarged Conference to decide the future of the Third Legacy in '55. They expressed confidence that a "standard-size" 1955 Conference would represent A.A. faithfully and wisely, even though half the members would be "first year" people.

The Conference also approved a proposal for a 20th anniversary meeting, open to all A.A.s (similar to the 1950 Cleveland meeting) to begin the day following the close of the '55 Conference. The "Convention Committee," to cooperate in determination of a time and site, will include four persons designated by the Trustees and the following delegates: DeWeese (Miss.), Smith (Springfield, Mass.), O'Neil, (Montana), Phelps (Corpus Christi, Texas), Goode (Tenn.), Buchanan (Buffalo) and Hanson (Wyo.).

6. "TWENTY-FOUR HOURS A DAY" BOOK
 7. PAMPHLET ON OLDER MEMBER & "SLIPS"
 8. PRISON AND HOSPITAL LISTINGS
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The Conference was asked to consider the offer of the publisher who wished to give to A.A. Publishing, Inc. publication rights to the booklet, "Twenty-Four Hours a Day."

A two-page letter from the publisher, favoring this proposal and answering certain objections to the proposal, was read to the Conference. The letter noted that current net profit from sales of the booklet is about \$5,300 annually. Requests that A.A. Publishing, Inc. undertake publication of the booklet have been received from many areas, largely as the result of suggestions by the present publisher, it was reported.

Comment by the Delegates indicated they felt it unwise to set a precedent in the case of this booklet and expressed fear that A.A. Publishing "would be flooded with similar requests" if it did so. The Delegate from the State in which the booklet is published said it was the consensus of his group and of his area that the proposal not be approved.

Following full discussion of the proposal, the Conference adopted a resolution that publication rights to "Twenty-Four Hours a Day" not be accepted and further asked that the publisher be thanked for his offer.

A proposal that "A.A. Publishing, Inc. should produce a Conference-approved pamphlet on the general theme of the role and attitude of the older member of A.A., with specific reference to conditions and attitudes that lead to 'slips'," was not approved by the Conference.

Points made by several delegates:

1. One area feels that A.A. "may be getting into the publishing business."
 2. The subject might be regarded as negative, and possibly misunderstood.
 3. The subject might be handled in The A.A. Grapevine.
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Following the expression of viewpoints from many Areas, the Conference voted not to approve the proposal to list Hospital and Prison Groups in the 1955 Directory. It was agreed that, while it was in the spirit of A.A. to regard all groups as essential parts of the fellowship, certain problems might arise if groups in this category are listed.

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9. "RELIGION AND A.A." PAMPHLET
 10. GENERAL SERVICE REPRESENTATIVE PLAN
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The Conference gave careful consideration to a proposal that A.A. Publishing, Inc. be asked to produce a pamphlet on the general subject, "Religion and A.A.," paralleling in objective and purposes the present work entitled "Medicine Looks at A.A."

It was emphasized that the title of such a pamphlet, if published, should properly be "Religion Looks at A.A.," and that it might well be a companion piece to the older work reflecting medical opinion of A.A.. However, it was soon evident that Delegates reflected the view that the movement was not now prepared to approve the proposal.

It was suggested in a letter from a Trustee, absent because of illness, that the title, "Religion and A.A.," suggested "too close a connection" but that "Religion Looks at A.A." might lead newcomers to investigate what others really thought when they looked at A.A.

The Conference voted not to publish the proposed pamphlet at this time.

Two parts of a three-part proposal for a "General Service Representative" Plan were adopted by the Conference. They are:

- A. "That the Group Representative described in the Third Legacy Pamphlet be designated the "General Service Representative."
- B. "That the 'General Service Representative,' in addition to electing his Area Committeeman and Regional Delegate to the General Service Conference, should act as the representative of the group in General Service activities and as the representative of A.A.'s General Services in the group."

Under this plan, the Group Representative will be listed in the A.A. Directory, succeeding the Secretary in the listings, except where the groups may designate the Secretary to "double" as Group Representative. A great deal of record-keeping detail can be eliminated under this plan, it was reported, since the Group Representatives would be the same "for a year or two."

The third part of the proposal, recommending consolidation of several items of General Service Conference literature into a "General Service Handbook," was tabled for further study and consideration at the 1955 Conference.

TWELFTH STEP HOUSES AND WORKSHOPS

The District of Columbia, the Los Angeles area, the State of Utah and New York City were represented on a special panel reporting and commenting on Twelfth Step House and Workshop experience in various sections of the country.

In the city of Washington, it was emphasized, the special rehabilitation facilities are handled on an individual basis, with about 300 persons having offered to subscribe from \$1 to \$5 monthly to support a "Home, Inc." The local government assists by providing a house at \$1-a-year rental. Safeguards followed include: (1) Don't let the Home be used for "one-night stands," (2) Keep only those who want to do something about their problem, (3) Provide facilities for from one to three weeks. All implications of charity are avoided. Newcomers keep tabs on what their use of facilities actually costs. Those who wish to do so can repay as they are able to; to date 90% have done so. A.A. meetings were kept out for a year but now a weekly meeting is held in the Home.

The Los Angeles area delegate outlined the extensive program of rehabilitation centers in his area. Sources of supporting income include A.A. donations, A.A. dances, a "coffee kitty," and even an occasional fashion show. In the four or five years of this activity, there has never been enough money to plan more than two months ahead. The "success ratio" in two representative centers is about 20%; in other centers a higher percentage "get the program." Ever-present problems: Management of the centers, financing and "who is worth saving." Possible dangers cited by the Delegate include the temptation to utilize the centers as a substitute for personal 12th Step work. Only restriction on admissions is that the alcoholic must have been sober 24 hours. Board members (Trustees) are all A.A.s.

Utah has three rehabilitation centers, responsible for returning several hundred men and women to sobriety each year. Each center organized independently, with about 10% of a typical operating budget contributed by city, county and state agencies. A \$12-weekly fee is charged, plus medical fees, if needed, and these charges can be financed. "A.A. is the only therapy used," with three meetings a week in each center. Approximately 50% are "effectively rehabilitated." Many individuals do not "get the program solidly" until after fourth or fifth try. About 750 to 800 alcoholics are handled yearly, at average "recovery" cost of \$27. (A recent State study indicates each alcoholic costs the taxpayer \$521!) Budgets deliberately kept small, administered by board of both alcoholics and non-alcoholics.

The New York City delegate reported that the local Twelfth Step House had been closed, after more than five years of operation. Factors responsible for the failure of the experiment included, he suggested, over-emphasis on material factors, deviations from Traditional A.A. practice and attempts to do things other agencies can do better. No basic services to alcoholics suffered as a result of the closing. The Municipal Lodging House, on referral from Intergroup, provides shelter. A city work camp provides rehabilitative care for 30-day periods or longer, if needed. Individual A.A.s are handling job referrals. Plans for reopening the center, adhering more closely than previously to A.A. Traditions, is under way.

LOCAL ACTIVITIES OF GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE COMMITTEES

Dallas, San Francisco, North Carolina and Ontario, Canada were represented on the special panel that outlined a number of effective ways of stimulating awareness of the scope and variety of Service Headquarters activities and their importance to the survival of A.A.

Specific techniques described and recommended by panel participants included:

1. Use of special "Area" letterheads by a Delegate who mailed a letter to all groups in his area during his stay at last year's Conference. Groups later commented they felt they were "really represented."
2. Use of four quarterly area meetings, held on Saturday nights, closed to public and featuring report on Conference, followed by an outstanding A.A. speaker not previously heard in a particular area.
3. Use of G.S.H. turnover presentation, "Service--the Third Legacy," supplemented by display of particular items of literature.
4. Free distribution of folder, "Your General Service" at special meetings.
5. Frequent emphasis on reasons for the need for both Central or Intergroup Office services and for Headquarters services.
6. Series of special meetings for group secretaries to explain real purpose of Handbook & Directory.
7. Periodic meetings of Group Representatives, where conditions permit.
8. Publication, in informal monthly journals, of articles on General Services.
9. Emphasis on giving Group Representatives specific things to do other than merely collecting funds for General Service Headquarters.
10. Use of a special, easily-portable literature display board.
11. Clear divisions of responsibility between Central Office committees and General Service Conference area committees.
12. Periodic "drives" directing attention to value of The A.A. Grapevine.
13. Carefully-organized programs making A.A. available in prisons, offering sponsorship upon release, and to sailors at all ports within an area.
14. Exploratory work in setting up new groups where the size of the population suggests the need.
15. Preparation of a local statement on "You and Your Third Legacy," for filing in Secretary's Handbook or in personal A.A. files.
16. Preparation and distribution of special reprints of talk by the 1953 Conference Chairman. ("The Conference, A.A. and Society.")
17. Distribution of the pamphlet "Your Role in General Service," to "older" members in an area, as well as Group Representatives.
18. Heavy emphasis on personal contact, rather than use of printed material, to tell the story of Headquarters services.
19. Avoidance of over-emphasis on fund appeals, stressing instead what the services are and the need for them, and arranging that Group Representatives, who know own members best, actually follow up fund appeals.
20. Importance of covering groups outside large centers which, collectively, constitute large part of A.A.; give attention to individual outlying groups, when necessary, and lay out General Service Areas with convenience of meetings clearly in mind.

SPECIAL MEETING FOR AREA DELEGATES ONLY

An innovation of the 1954 Conference was the scheduling of a special session limited to Delegates representing specific areas. All other Conference members, including Trustees and Headquarters staff people were excluded from the meeting. That the experiment was considered a success was indicated by the Delegates' request that this type of meeting be perpetuated in the future and by the members' insistence on discussing only those matters affecting A.A. as a whole.

Other decisions reached at the meeting included:

1. Overwhelming support of the proposal that Discounts on books sold to groups be discontinued, as recommended by a number of groups. (Vote was 67 for the proposal out of a total of 75 Delegates.)
2. Agreement that the Third Legacy pamphlet allows latitude in the matter of procedures involved in electing Committeemen in the various Areas.
3. Agreement that the delegates would take affirmative action to stimulate subscription and bulk sales of The A.A. Grapevine.
4. Agreement "that all monies collected through the elimination of book discounts be distinctly earmarked for the Reserve Account of The Alcoholic Foundation and that, unless a financial emergency should arise, the discount should be automatically reinstated when the balance in the Reserve Fund reached \$300,000."
5. Approval of the idea "that Bill be informed that the General Service Conference is willing to take over the responsibility for the selection of all Trustees if and when Bill and the Trustees are ready for the General Service Conference to do so."
6. Adoption of the following resolution unanimously by voice vote:
"At this session of the General Service Conference, attended only by area Delegates, this being the only means and method we have of conveying our heartfelt sentiments, it was moved:

That this General Service Conference extends to Bill Wilson our love, admiration, appreciation, and deep gratitude for his untiring efforts over the years in leading us into this way of life which has brought to us undescribable peace of mind, contentment, happiness, and serenity, and we hope and pray for him and Lois good health and many, many years of inspirational service; and, without naming the members of the General Service Staff, to them and every clerk and other employee who have done such a magnificent job in carrying the message to the untold thousands who are yet sick and who do not know, and for the guidance, help, and inspiration they have given to each and every A.A., our heartfelt thanks, and, we especially desire to express to Bernard Smith our sincere appreciation and gratitude for his wise counsel, guidance and help, and to each member of the Board of Trustees, our gratitude for the magnificent job they have done in carrying on. And, be it further resolved that this resolution be spread upon the minutes of this Conference and a copy of it printed in the earliest issue of the Grapevine."

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS

Following the practice adopted at the 1953 Conference, special opportunities were again made available so that any pertinent question relating to the Conference or to Headquarters services could be asked anonymously by the Delegates. A question box was prominently displayed in the meeting room from the time the first delegates arrived until the conclusion of the Conference. At intervals the box was unlocked and the comments, suggestions, questions or criticisms were read to the full Conference. Many of the points raised were answered, or otherwise handled, on the floor of the Conference; others were referred to committees for study and recommendations. Following is a summary indicating the scope of Operation Questions Anonymous:

<u>Question</u>	<u>Disposition</u>
1. Should Delegates discuss with their home groups a recommendation that in the future they (Delegates) be given leeway to "vote their own consciences in the interest of A.A. as a whole" on particular policy matters?	Referred to Policy Committee.
2. How can a person be deterred from use of references to A.A. in advertising a retreat?	Referred to Policy Committee.
3. Would it be desirable to set aside a given period as "Conference Month?"	Deferred for discussion in connection with another topic.
4. Suggested that Conference should definitely continue for next two years, and that there is no need to increase number of Trustees now.	Deferred for discussion in connection with another topic.
5. Where does A.A. enter the picture where the "drifter" alcoholic is concerned?	Agreed that this was a matter for individual decision.
6. Recommended ways and means be explored to put all A.A. interests on a pay-as-you-go plan.	Referred to Finance Committee.
7. Requested guidance on problems of "mis-use" of club rooms.	Conference agreed this is a local, rather than general, problem.

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS
(Continued)

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| 8. Can Headquarters give the Areas more time, in the future, when proposals are submitted prior to Conference? | An effort will be made to do this, although it may be difficult to give much more than the ten weeks' "consideration period" that was given in the case of the nine 1954 pre-Conference proposals. |
| 9. Could some areas get along without General Service Headquarters? | No discussion, by general consent. |
| 10. Could the Directory section of the Handbook show time and place of meetings? | Cost would be prohibitive. About 20 States already have such Directories. Suggested that Delegates interested in problem discuss individually. |
| 11. Is it a violation of A.A. Tradition to sell tickets for A.A. affairs to the general public? | Agreed that this is a matter best solved at local level. |
| 12. Should the movement have a "General Service Month" - similar to "Tradition Month?" | Referred to Policy Committee. |
| 13. Is the A.A. reference to "no dues or fees" subject to misunderstanding, and therefore inappropriate?" | Bill's comments on same question in 1953 were reviewed. |
| 14. Does Bill or the Foundation have any plan for handling pre-A.A. debts (since forgiven) that Bill has mentioned, and "can we help in any way?" | Bill pointed out he believed it a sound principle in A.A. that each should work out his own debts. Expressing appreciation of helpfulness suggested, he said that, as a writer, he now had the means to work off these old debts. If the task should not be completed during his lifetime, he suggested, it might then become a movement matter. |
| 15. Inquiry about Bedford Hills item in financial report. | Bill reviewed his and Lois' experience in early days at Bedford Hills when the stream of visitors first began to be a financial and physical strain, "far above average for an A.A." even though related directly to his work in the movement. Recognizing this situation, the Trustees authorized out-of-pocket expense fund for such items as entertainment of A.A. visitors, part-time help for Lois, telephone expenses and similar items. |

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS
(Continued)

16. Inquiry about the position and duties of the General Service Manager and their significance.
- A succession of volunteer workers had not been able to handle the increasingly complex problem of directing Headquarters, Bill pointed out. Hank had been engaged on a part time basis, because it was considered unfair to expect him to devote so much of his time so continuously as a volunteer. As to any fear of a struggle for prestige or position at some time in the future, Bill said that one reason for the Conference was to insure that there would be "no succession excepting the Conference as holders of the Third Legacy." We needn't worry one bit about the so-called Crown Prince issue," Bill said. He emphasized that the handling of internal operations is still on an experimental basis.
17. Can costs of producing the Grapevine be reduced?
- The Editor pointed out that naturally a less attractive, less useful, publication could be produced for less money. But costs are already "about as low as we can go" and still maintain standards that make the magazine readable and long-lasting. During discussion, it was pointed out that circulation increases, particularly through bulk sales, would strengthen the magazine's financial position and also be in line with the needs of those who are unable to pay for a year's subscription at one time.
18. Does Headquarters recommend seeking local press and radio-TV attention for A.A., using the new materials provided last year, and does this pose any problems?
- The staff member in charge of Group Relations reported that "promotion" of the special material was, of course, not sought, but that any fears of the danger of distributing the material to the groups had been groundless. There has been "real understanding" of our public relations Tradition and no misuse of the material had come to Headquarters' attention.
19. Recommendation that one budget be set up for Headquarters operations.
- Deferred for later discussion in connection with another topic.
20. Suggestion made that special "return envelopes" be distributed with appeals for funds.
- Referred to Finance Committee.

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS
(Continued)

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| 21. Special Headquarters bulletin for Intergroup secretaries proposed. | Referred to Policy Committee. |
| 22. Should Intergroup secretaries be invited to Conferences? | Referred to Policy Committee. |
| 23. What do you think of starting a Voluntary Birthday Contribution to General Service Headquarters in lieu of the \$2.00 or \$2.50 per head per year? | Agreed that this was a matter for further individual consideration and possible discussion in local areas. |
| 24. How about placing a coin box on proposed literature racks? | Referred to Literature Committee. |
| 25. Are we getting too much literature? | Referred to Literature Committee. |
| 26. Should A.A. literature have a special identifying insignia? | Referred to Literature Committee. |
| 27. Should Headquarters produce a "52-Week Discussion Book?" | Referred to Literature Committee. |
| 28. Is there danger that we may reprint too many articles first published in outside journals? | Referred to Literature Committee. |
| 29. Need for defining such words as "area," "region," "locality" etc. in A.A. Conference material. | Referred to Literature Committee. |
| 30. In distribution of various types of literature at group level, where should emphasis lie (Books? Grapevine? Etc.?) | Referred to Literature Committee. |
| 31. How can we make it easier for newcomers to find A.A.? | Agreed that this is a local matter, primarily. |
| 32. Is the expense of the Directory and of the monthly Bulletins warranted? Few seem to use them. | Discussion disclosed strong sentiment for continuing these services, based on specific examples of benefits derived. |
| 33. How can "Handbook & Directory" be safeguarded from mis-use? | Generally agreed that this problem is not as serious as it once was, but that it may always have to be considered. |

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS
(Continued)

34. How does it happen that one Delegate is here for his 3rd year, in view of our concept of two-year rotation in Conference affairs? It was explained that the Delegate in question had first attended as an alternate. He was not named his Area's delegate until the following year.
35. Are copies of the large-size turnover presentation on Headquarters services, first shown at the 1953 Conference, still available for purchase and use by Delegates, Committeemen and Group Representatives? A limited number of copies are available. (These presentations were prepared on a non-profit basis and are distributed at \$25. a copy).
36. Could the size of the Directory be reduced by eliminating listing of local groups in Intergroup areas? The matter will be studied, although certain problems suggest that this might not be the most effective way of reducing costs without impairing service.
37. Would it not make sense to have a special committee of the Conference to consider many of the problems relating to the Grapevine that have been discussed here? Conference agreed, as did Grapevine editor, that such a committee could be helpful. The Committee, chosen by lot in the usual manner includes these Delegates:
Whitehead, Arizona
Wallace, Maritimes
Smith, Springfield, Mass.
Fred Clark, Indiana
Schif, Paxon, Ill.
Caldwell, R. I.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON LITERATURE

It is recommended that:

1. Insofar as is practicable, that all new literature be in a format suitable for mailing in a "#10" envelope.
2. That all Conference-approved literature have on its face, an identifying symbol.
3. That the two pamphlets, the 2nd edition of "Your Third Legacy" and "Your Role in the General Service Conference", be combined in reduced volume.
4. That the two pamphlets, "Structure and Services of A.A." and "Your General Service", be combined.
5. That the Conference Literature Committee be kept advised and consulted on all new pieces of literature.
6. That groups be circularized with tentative quantity prices and pictures of the literature display racks, models of which were shown at this Conference, to determine whether or not the project is feasible.
7. That all reprints such as those reproducing material from Fortune, Saturday Evening Post and Good Housekeeping, bear the credit line at the top of the cover and that the cover be in white to distinguish such reprints from Conference-approved literature.

REPORT OF THE FINANCE COMMITTEE

The Financial Report clearly points out the need for increased contributions to support the services. Therefore, it is recommended that:

The policy of seeking group contributions at the suggested minimum rate of \$2.00 per member per year be continued, and that greater efforts be made by all Delegates to increase not only the amount of group contributions but also the number of groups contributing. Furthermore, that the Delegates are asked to have their groups remit their contributions quarterly to the General Service Board.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

The Committee met and after appointing a new chairman, Wendell Haben, voted to continue activities as in the past.

In 1953, the Trustees Committee passed on the two names submitted to them by the Nominating Committee, Dan Hennessy and Sig Sandmore.

At this time the Committee feels that there is nothing further to report.

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON THE GRAPEVINE

Following the adoption by the Conference of a resolution suggesting some affirmative action with respect to the Grapevine, a Grapevine Committee was selected to meet during the Conference. At its meeting the Committee felt that emphasis should be placed on the value of the Grapevine in carrying the message of recovery and the following further resolution is presented:

RESOLVED:

1. That the Delegates on their return, incorporate in their report on the Conference, the suggestion that each group appoint a Grapevine reporter who will be responsible for subscription and bulk orders, and who will encourage members to submit articles and stories;
2. That each Delegate contact those groups in his area which do not have the Grapevine available at meetings and draw their attention to the importance and advantages of obtaining copies for the group either through monthly or yearly bulk orders; and
3. That Delegates emphasize the value of the Grapevine to the individual member.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON POLICY

The Committee recommends:

1. That Committeemen elected during the year be put on the General Service Conference mailing list in February. That the Delegate be put on the mailing list as soon as Headquarters is notified of his election by the outgoing Delegate.
2. That Delegate representation should not be changed during the five year period.
3. That the Third Legacy pamphlet should continue to be followed in determining Delegate representation.
4. That during the five year period, all ex-Delegates remain on General Conference mailing list.
5. That Groups who have not corresponded with Headquarters for two years or more be referred to the area Delegates for follow-up purposes before they are taken off the mailing list.
6. That any Group with a regular Secretary, registered with Headquarters shall be entitled to one vote in a State Assembly Meeting.
7. That Delegates remain in office for a full two-year term, expiring in April.
8. That Delegates come to the Conference being only tentatively instructed for the following reasons: (1) that each Delegate bring to the Conference the thinking of his area, and (2) that the maximum wisdom of the Conference be achieved and voted through the exchange of these ideas at the Conference.
9. That the policy adopted by the 1953 Conference in reference to the three-quarters majority rule be continued, that policy stated as follows: "No policy should be declared or action taken on matters liable to gravely affect A.A. as a whole unless by consent of at least three-quarters of the members present. A mere majority should not authorize action."

SPECIAL NOTE: Delegates from States with multiple representation were asked to provide Service Headquarters with a list of the groups in the separate Conference areas, as a means of improving service to the Delegates and the groups.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

REPORT OF AGENDA COMMITTEE

It was felt that the agenda for the present Conference be retained.

It was recommended that Delegates having suggestions for the Agenda for the closed or "unchaperoned" conference session send such suggestions to the Conference Secretary at least 90 days prior to the next Conference.

It was further recommended that the Agenda Committee, on behalf of all Delegates, wishes to thank Helen Brown, the Conference Secretary, for the splendid job she has done over the past year to make this Fourth General Service Conference the success that it is.

OTHER ADVISORY ACTIONS ADOPTED BY THE FULL CONFERENCE

1. Agreed to open the first business session of the Conference with a reading of the Preamble from Chapter V of the Big Book, together with the Twelve Suggested Steps and the Twelve Traditions.
2. Agreed that the opening session of each day would begin with some form of prayer, as may be suggested by the Delegates. All other sessions to open with a brief period of silence.
3. Agreed that the Conference would adjourn its final session with the recitation of the Lord's Prayer.
4. Chose, for the "Area Delegates Only" session, the following:
Weatherford of Alabama as Chairman (2nd-year member)
Kavanagh of Dixon, Ill., as vice-chairman (1st-year member)
5. Agreed on the principle of having a 2nd-year Delegate as Chairman of "Area Delegates Only" sessions, with the vice-chairman a 1st-year Delegate, succeeding to the chairmanship in the subsequent year.
6. Agreed that all arrangements for the proposed 20th Anniversary International Meeting, since they involve substantial financial commitments, be approved by the Board of Trustees.

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WEDNESDAY, APRIL 21

- Registration of Delegates
- Visits to Headquarters offices and other A.A. facilities in N.Y.

Evening

-- Dinner for Delegates
Greetings from Bill; Talk by Mr. Bernard B. Smith,
Conference Chairman

THURSDAY, APRIL 22

Morning

-- First Session - Reports

Afternoon

-- Second Session - Selection of Committees
Reports: Literature & "A.A. Grapevine"

Evening

-- Third Session - Trustees' report
Consideration of policy proposals

FRIDAY, APRIL 23

Morning

-- Fourth Session (For Area Delegates Only)

Afternoon

-- Fifth Session - Panel Discussions

Evening

-- Sixth Session - Discussion of matters suggested
at morning session

SATURDAY, APRIL 24

Morning

-- Seventh Session - Consideration of policy proposals

Afternoon

-- Eighth Session - Consideration of policy proposals

SUNDAY, APRIL 25

Afternoon

-- Final Conference Luncheon and Ninth Session
Committee Reports and Recommendations
Closing Talks: Bernard B. Smith
Bill W.

INTRODUCTION TO FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

It is one of the purposes of the General Service Conference to bring to the A.A. movement a wider knowledge of the functioning of the General Service Headquarters. Complete details of the financial aspects of the Headquarters are presented in the attached financial statements, which have been prepared by our independent certified public accountant from his reports.

A brief explanation of the corporate structure is necessary for a proper understanding of these statements. A.A. PUBLISHING, INC. (formerly Works Publishing, Inc.) is a stock corporation whose functions are the publication of Conference-approved literature and the operation of the Headquarters office. THE A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC. is a stock corporation which publishes our monthly magazine.

In THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC. there are three separate accounts; (1) General Fund, (2) General Service Headquarters and (3) General Service Conference. THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC. owns all of the capital stock of A.A. PUBLISHING, INC. and the full beneficial interest in the net assets and income of the A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Following is an index to the attached financial statements:

ALL CORPORATIONS	Combined Summary of Income and Expenses	Exhibit A
THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC.	Balance Sheet Income Statement	Exhibit B Exhibit C
A.A. PUBLISHING, INC.	Balance Sheet Income Statement	Exhibit D Exhibit E
THE A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.	Balance Sheet Income Statement	Exhibit F Exhibit G

COMBINED SUMMARY OF INCOME AND EXPENSES
YEARS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1953 AND 1952
THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC., A. A. PUBLISHING, INC., THE A. A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

	1953	1952
<u>THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC.</u>		
1. <u>GENERAL FUND</u>		
Costs of Trustees' Meetings, foreign translations, honorarium, rent and other expenses - Exhibit C	\$ 9,919.	\$ 7,462.
Less: Interest on Savings Accounts	<u>2,007.</u>	<u>1,644.</u>
Net Expense	\$ 7,912.	\$ 5,818.
2. <u>GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS</u>		
Salaries, rent, stationery, postage, printing, telephone, taxes, etc. - Exhibit E	140,053.	102,815.
Less: A.A. Publishing, Inc. share	<u>27,190.</u>	<u>10,376.</u>
Net Expense	112,863.	92,439.
3. <u>GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE</u>		
Travel, hotels, meals, meetings, reports, salary, etc.-Exhibit C	19,832.	16,227.
Less: Conference Fund revenue	<u>11,157.</u>	<u>10,057.</u>
Net Expense	<u>8,675.</u>	<u>6,170.</u>
Net Cost of Services	129,450.	104,427.
Group Contributions	<u>113,057.</u>	<u>106,195.</u>
Excess of Contributions - (Cost)	(16,393.)	1,768.
<u>A. A. PUBLISHING, INC. - Exhibit E</u>		
Cost of producing materials sold	83,724.	53,716.
Portion of G.S.H. expenses (above)	27,190.	10,376.
Editing, research, legal, accounting		
Bedford Hills expense, travel and other expenses	<u>12,277.</u>	<u>13,482.</u>
	123,191.	77,574.
Sales of books, pamphlets, etc.	<u>182,271.</u>	<u>111,476.</u>
Excess of Income	59,080.	33,902.
<u>A. A. GRAPEVINE, INC. - Exhibit G</u>		
Printing and mailing	39,073.	37,115.
Salaries, rent, telephone, postage, taxes and other expenses	<u>36,484.</u>	<u>36,878.</u>
	75,557.	73,993.
Subscriptions, sales and interest	<u>80,540.</u>	<u>79,034.</u>
Excess of Income	<u>4,983.</u>	<u>5,041.</u>
COMBINED NET INCOME FOR YEAR	47,670.	40,711.
ACCUMULATED INCOME		
Balance, January 1	156,368.	115,657.
Balance, December 31	<u>204,038.</u>	<u>156,368.</u>

THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC.
BALANCE SHEET
DECEMBER 31, 1953 AND 1952

ASSETS

GENERAL FUND		\$162,073.65		\$128,010.69
Cash in commercial account	\$ 42,107.38		\$ 16,731.99	
Cash in savings accounts	84,700.27		72,692.70	
Prepaid expenses	1,105.00		425.00	
Advances to Group Contrib.Fund	20,000.00		24,000.00	
Investment in and advances to The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	13,661.00		13,661.00	
Investment in A.A. Publishing, Inc.	<u>500.00</u>		<u>500.00</u>	
GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND		26,488.89		25,573.96
Cash in commercial account	26,451.39		25,536.46	
U.S. Savings Bonds (at cost)	<u>37.50</u>		<u>37.50</u>	
CONFERENCE FUND		2,408.31		3,872.79
Cash in commercial account	1,975.59		3,285.75	
Due from Group Contribution Fund	285.50		25.00	
Due from A.A. Publishing, Inc.	5.00		26.10	
Prepaid expenses - subsequent year's Conference	<u>142.22</u>		<u>535.94</u>	
<u>Total Assets</u>		<u>190,970.85</u>		<u>157,457.44</u>

LIABILITIES

GENERAL FUND		\$ 600.00		\$ 4.00
Accounts payable	\$ 500.00			
Due A.A. Publishing, Inc.	<u>100.00</u>		\$ <u>4.00</u>	
GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND		36,010.51		35,289.25
Due A.A. Publishing, Inc.	15,725.01		11,264.25	
Due other Funds	<u>20,285.50</u>		<u>24,025.00</u>	
CONFERENCE FUND		1,532.79		2,943.56
Accounts Payable			88.28	
Deferred income - subsequent year's Conference	<u>1,532.79</u>		<u>2,855.28</u>	
<u>Total Liabilities</u>		38,143.30		38,236.81
PRINCIPAL OF FUNDS (Exhibit C)		152,827.55		119,220.63
GENERAL FUND	161,473.65		128,006.69	
GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND	(9,521.62)		(9,715.29)	
CONFERENCE FUND	<u>875.52</u>		<u>929.23</u>	
<u>Total Liabilities and Principal</u>		<u>190,970.85</u>		<u>157,457.44</u>

(Parentheses denote red figures)

THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC.
STATEMENT OF INCOME, EXPENSES AND PRINCIPAL OF FUNDS
YEARS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1953 AND 1952

	1953		1952
GENERAL FUND			
Dividends, A.A. Publishing, Inc.	\$ 50,000.00		\$ 35,000.00
Interest on Savings Accounts	<u>2,007.57</u>		<u>1,643.78</u>
Total Income	\$ 52,007.57		\$ 36,643.78
Rent	1,200.00		1,200.00
Service Office travel	6.17		678.59
Expenses of Trustees' Meetings	3,224.41		3,086.08
Foreign language pamphlets	2,775.84		350.00
Honorarium	1,500.00		1,000.00
Accounting and other expenses	1,212.95		1,147.65
Grant to Conference Fund	<u>8,621.24</u>		<u>6,000.00</u>
Total Expenses	<u>18,540.61</u>		<u>13,462.32</u>
Excess of Income	33,466.96		23,181.46
Principal: Balance, January 1	128,006.69		104,825.23
Balance, December 31 (Exhibit B)	<u><u>161,473.65</u></u>		<u><u>128,006.69</u></u>
GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND			
Contributions received	\$113,056.86		\$106,195.59
Expenses of General Service Office (Exhibit E)	<u>112,863.19</u>		<u>92,439.18</u>
Excess of Income	193.67		13,756.41
Principal: Balance, January 1 (deficit)	(9,715.29)		(23,471.70)
Balance, December 31 (Exhibit B)	<u><u>(9,521.62)</u></u>		<u><u>(9,715.29)</u></u>
CONFERENCE FUND			
Subscriptions from Groups	\$ 8,648.17		\$ 9,732.50
Sales of Third Legacy pamphlet	75.60		324.90
Grant from General Fund	8,621.24		6,000.00
Costs transferred to A.A. Publishing, Inc.:			
Conference Report & Highlights	552.52		
Presentation charts	1,100.00		
Record rights	<u>780.55</u>		
Total Income	\$ 19,778.08		\$ 16,057.40
Delegates' transportation expense	3,841.64		4,595.69
Hotels, meals and meetings	9,542.60		9,273.36
Postage, office supplies and expense	1,126.73		1,158.41
Secretarial salaries	1,200.00		1,200.00
Conference Report & Highlights	1,643.66		
Presentation charts	1,696.61		
Recording Conference sessions	<u>780.55</u>		
Total Expenses	<u>19,831.79</u>		<u>16,227.46</u>
Excess of Expense	(53.71)		(170.06)
Principal: Balance, January 1	929.23		1,099.29
Balance, December 31 (Exhibit B)	<u><u>875.52</u></u>		<u><u>929.23</u></u>

(Parentheses denote red figures)

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS PUBLISHING, INC.
BALANCE SHEET
DECEMBER 31, 1953 AND 1952

<u>ASSETS</u>	<u>1953</u>	<u>1952</u>
Cash on hand and in bank	\$ 19,865.83	\$ 20,446.80
Accounts Receivable		
Trade customers (after reserve of \$800 in each year	\$ 7,456.14	\$ 5,121.01
The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.	15,947.21	11,303.25
Other	<u>1,100.00</u>	<u>16,424.26</u>
Inventories	35,478.38	32,450.00
Prepaid expenses	416.67	2,500.00
Book plates, equipment copyrights and goodwill	<u>1.00</u>	<u>1.00</u>
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>80,265.23</u>	<u>71,822.06</u>

<u>LIABILITIES</u>		
Accounts payable	4,768.89	6,282.26
Due The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.	127.20	61.10
Accrued royalties	4,230.91	3,455.55
Accrued taxes	<u>440.83</u>	<u>406.08</u>
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>9,567.83</u>	<u>10,204.99</u>

<u>CAPITAL</u>		
Capital stock issued and out- standing Earnings retained in the Business:	500.00	500.00
Balance, January 1	61,117.07	62,214.95
Net Income for Year (Exhibit E)	<u>59,080.33</u>	<u>33,902.12</u>
	120,197.40	96,117.07
Deduct: Dividends paid	<u>50,000.00</u>	<u>35,000.00</u>
Balance, December 31	<u>70,197.40</u>	<u>61,117.07</u>
<u>Total Capital</u>	<u>70,697.40</u>	<u>61,617.07</u>
<u>Total Liabilities and Capital</u>	<u>80,265.23</u>	<u>71,822.06</u>

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS PUBLISHING, INC.
INCOME STATEMENT
YEARS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1953 AND 1952

	<u>1953</u>		<u>1952</u>	
NET SALES				
Books	\$119,041.75		\$ 67,599.08	
Pamphlets	53,778.79		36,411.48	
Records	1,861.00		1,554.56	
Other products	<u>7,589.16</u>	\$182,270.70	<u>5,910.52</u>	\$111,475.64
COST OF SALES				
Books	21,754.74		15,683.54	
Pamphlets	24,466.71		17,330.80	
Records	920.15		506.42	
Other products	4,230.21		1,350.75	
Packing supplies	1,861.46		1,043.68	
Writing fees	7,000.00		3,500.00	
Royalties	<u>23,490.29</u>	<u>83,723.56</u>	<u>14,300.48</u>	<u>53,715.67</u>
GROSS PROFIT FROM SALES		<u>98,547.14</u>		<u>57,759.97</u>
OPERATING EXPENSES				
Office Expenses:				
Salaries	76,756.19		59,743.63	
Postage and express	12,783.23		12,371.74	
Stationery and supplies	4,025.39		2,965.96	
Rent and electricity	14,602.30		11,500.84	
Telephone and telegraph	2,215.49		2,010.73	
Payroll taxes and insurance	3,318.10		1,849.14	
Service Office printing	11,201.44		5,310.97	
Office equipment	5,984.19		2,131.17	
Other office expenses	<u>9,166.91</u>		<u>4,931.19</u>	
Total Office Expenses	140,053.24		102,815.37	
Less: Portion payable by The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.	<u>112,863.19</u>	27,190.05	<u>92,439.18</u>	10,376.19
Other Expenses:				
Entertainment	469.11		254.20	
Travel	556.48			
Bedford Hills expense	3,752.95		3,495.12	
Accounting and legal	3,402.03		2,500.00	
Taxes, other than payroll	309.86		258.78	
Editing and research	3,309.07		6,702.38	
Loss on doubtful accounts	238.12		144.61	
Books donated to Great Britain Book Publishing Committee	<u>239.14</u>	<u>12,276.76</u>	<u>126.57</u>	<u>13,481.66</u>
Total Operating Expenses		<u>39,466.81</u>		<u>23,857.85</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit D)		<u>59,080.33</u>		<u>33,902.12</u>

THE ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
BALANCE SHEET
DECEMBER 31, 1953 AND 1952

	1953	1952
<u>ASSETS</u>		
CASH	\$ 21,930.86	\$ 15,178.07
Commercial account	\$ 15,721.09	\$ 12,078.07
Savings account	6,109.77	3,000.00
Petty cash fund	<u>100.00</u>	<u>100.00</u>
ACCOUNTS RECEIVABLE	1,411.19	1,224.52
DEFERRED CHARGES	5,847.79	6,045.32
Mailing and office supplies on hand	2,384.98	2,146.84
Prepaid rent	300.00	500.00
Printing and mailing January issue	<u>3,162.81</u>	<u>3,398.48</u>
FIXED ASSETS	3,100.19	3,507.74
Furniture and equipment	6,159.53	5,905.20
Less: Accumulated Depreciation	<u>3,059.34</u>	<u>2,397.46</u>
<u>TOTAL ASSETS</u>	<u>32,290.03</u>	<u>25,955.65</u>
<u>LIABILITIES</u>		
ACCOUNTS AND ACCRUALS PAYABLE	3,471.82	3,204.50
Accounts payable and advance payments	3,368.29	3,083.23
Accrued taxes	<u>103.53</u>	<u>121.27</u>
ADVANCED BY THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC.	13,660.00	13,660.00
Unearned subscription income	<u>34,144.76</u>	<u>33,060.58</u>
<u>TOTAL LIABILITIES</u>	<u>51,276.58</u>	<u>49,925.08</u>
<u>CAPITAL AND DEFICIT</u>		
Capital stock - no par value		
Authorized, issued and outstanding		
3 shs Class A, 3 shs Class B	1.00	1.00
Deficit from operations	(18,987.55)	(23,970.43)
Balance, January 1	(23,970.43)	(29,011.67)
Net Income for Period (Exhibit G)	<u>4,982.88</u>	<u>5,041.24</u>
<u>DEFICIT LESS CAPITAL</u>	<u>(18,986.55)</u>	<u>(23,969.43)</u>
<u>TOTAL LIABILITIES LESS DEFICIT</u>	<u>32,290.03</u>	<u>25,955.65</u>

(Parentheses denote red figures)

THE ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
INCOME STATEMENT
12 MONTHS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1953 AND 1952

	<u>1953</u>	<u>1952</u>
INCOME		
Unearned income, January 1	\$ 33,060.58	\$ 33,282.67
Add: Subscriptions received	<u>51,995.24</u>	<u>50,016.31</u>
	85,055.82	83,298.98
Less: Portion applicable to subsequent issues	<u>34,144.76</u>	<u>33,060.58</u>
Income from subscriptions	50,911.06	50,238.40
Other sales	29,540.82	28,795.80
Interest on savings account	<u>88.52</u>	
<u>TOTAL INCOME</u>	<u>\$ 80,540.40</u>	<u>\$ 79,034.20</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING COSTS	49,460.49	50,189.37
Salaries	7,813.42	9,967.82
Printing	31,271.95	26,939.38
Mailing	7,801.00	10,175.50
Printing supplies	166.00	346.13
Rent and telephone	1,499.87	1,453.17
Depreciation	74.76	429.07
Other costs	<u>833.49</u>	<u>878.30</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS EXPENSES	26,097.03	23,803.59
Salaries	15,280.46	13,827.18
Office supplies and expense	1,468.69	2,165.47
Rent and telephone	1,772.64	1,668.54
Postage and miscellaneous	2,013.64	2,202.70
Accounting	900.00	700.00
Taxes	1,196.56	953.45
Promotion	2,582.82	1,698.90
Depreciation	<u>882.22</u>	<u>587.35</u>
<u>TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES</u>	<u>75,557.52</u>	<u>73,992.96</u>
<u>NET INCOME FOR PERIOD (Exhibit F)</u>	<u>4,982.88</u>	<u>5,041.24</u>

NOTE: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. operates on a fiscal year ended March 31, so that the above figures have been compiled from quarterly reports prepared for the management.

1953 CONTRIBUTIONS BY GROUPS TO THE
GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS FUND

<u>State</u>	<u>Member- ship</u>	<u>No. of Groups</u>	<u>No. of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>% of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>* Amt of Contrib.</u>
Alabama	1,136	41	17	41%	\$ 872.00
Arizona	557	34	17	50	477.00
Arkansas	854	52	30	58	822.00
California	11,017	495	336	68	16,316.24
Colorado	909	59	41	70	1,791.00
Connecticut	1,103	54	30	56	1,253.00
Delaware	354	15	12	80	265.50
District of Columbia	543	9	9	100	400.00
Florida	2,304	114	78	68	6,120.36
Georgia	969	46	20	43	548.00
Idaho	395	25	10	40	303.50
Illinois	5,270	273	240	88	3,167.00
Indiana	1,697	106	68	64	2,355.50
Iowa	1,688	75	42	56	2,236.00
Kansas	1,536	63	43	68	1,305.50
Kentucky	770	53	24	45	1,289.78
Louisiana	789	35	18	51	608.50
Maine	693	38	23	61	598.23
Maryland	919	44	29	66	1,133.86
Massachusetts	2,459	127	87	67	3,216.64
Michigan	3,225	183	119	65	5,504.75
Minnesota	1,632	82	53	65	3,424.46
Mississippi	712	31	26	84	1,040.00
Missouri	2,177	90	78	87	2,611.00
Montana	299	24	9	38	306.00
Nebraska	368	34	23	68	489.00
Nevada	186	8	6	75	260.00
New Hampshire	247	21	13	62	285.00
New Jersey	2,255	127	72	57	2,791.35
New Mexico	649	30	24	80	623.30
New York	7,217	292	170	58	7,741.80
North Carolina	1,884	101	55	54	2,175.00
North Dakota	443	30	13	43	238.00
Ohio	7,952	315	141	45	5,470.50
Oklahoma	839	57	40	71	1,693.25

1953 CONTRIBUTIONS BY GROUPS TO THE
GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS FUND

<u>State</u>	<u>Member- ship</u>	<u>No. of Groups</u>	<u>No. of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>% of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>* Amt. of Contrib.</u>
Oregon	612	43	25	58%	\$ 955.47
Pennsylvania	3,149	178	117	66	3,525.08
Rhode Island	233	17	7	41	172.00
South Carolina	962	62	34	55	1,014.00
South Dakota	558	26	18	69	326.00
Tennessee	632	39	21	54	973.00
Texas	4,505	207	129	62	5,218.15
Utah	1,040	46	29	63	586.00
Vermont	290	19	14	74	500.00
Virginia	1,741	69	43	62	2,224.50
Washington	1,532	88	60	68	2,231.38
West Virginia	770	47	30	64	1,035.00
Wisconsin	2,101	116	75	65	2,704.00
Wyoming	<u>157</u>	<u>19</u>	<u>10</u>	<u>53</u>	<u>236.00</u>
Total for U.S.A.	84,329	4,159	2,628	63%	\$101,433.60

C A N A D A

Alberta	510	31	20	65	\$ 500.41
British Columbia	1,451	88	43	49	2,572.81
Manitoba	510	23	11	48	549.50
New Brunswick	586	25	7	28	314.12
Newfoundland	68	4	3	75	60.00
Nova Scotia	646	37	14	38	699.10
Ontario	2,760	185	111	60	3,258.50
Prince Edward Island	107	4	2	50	129.25
Quebec	773	61	26	43	646.00
Saskatchewan	693	45	23	51	419.25
Yukon Territory	<u>5</u>	<u>1</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>-</u>
Total for Canada	8,114	504	260	52%	\$9,148.94
**Hospital Groups	4,425	151			128.00
**Prison Groups	12,149	233			165.25

1953 CONTRIBUTIONS BY GROUPS TO THE
GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS FUND

	<u>Member- ship</u>	<u>No. of Groups</u>	<u>No. of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>% of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>* Amt. of Contrib.</u>
58 Countries Outside the U.S.A. and Canada	8,695	354	54	15%	\$ 1,213.17
*Lone Members	168				300.53
Internationalists	98				204.00
Anonymous Donors			-		976.50
Grand Total	117,978	5,401	2,942	59%	\$113,269.46

* Contributions of Lone Members included in State, Province and Foreign totals.

** Not included in calculating total percentage of groups contributing.

CONTRIBUTIONS BY GROUPS TO THE
1954 CONFERENCE FUND

<u>U.S.A.</u>	<u>No. of Groups</u>	<u>No. of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>% of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>Amt. of Contrib.</u>
Alabama	41	6	15%	\$ 60.00
Arizona	34	7	21	50.00
Arkansas	52	13	25	90.00
California	495	137	28	945.00
Colorado	59	16	27	105.00
Connecticut	54	6	11	45.00
Delaware	15	1	7	5.00
District of Columbia	9	5	56	37.00
Florida	114	27	24	270.00
Georgia	46	11	24	80.00
Idaho	25	6	24	50.00
Illinois	273	113	41	613.50
Indiana	106	18	17	152.00
Iowa	75	7	9	45.00
Kansas	63	12	19	106.00
Kentucky	53	13	25	90.00
Louisiana	35	7	20	40.00
Maine	38	5	13	30.00
Maryland	44	5	11	30.00
Massachusetts	127	65	51	549.00
Michigan	183	43	23	300.00
Minnesota	82	13	16	95.00
Mississippi	31	6	19	35.00
Missouri	90	12	13	75.00
Montana	24	6	25	55.00
Nebraska	34	11	32	85.00
Nevada	8	2	25	15.00
New Hampshire	21	5	24	30.00
New Jersey	127	26	20	200.00
New Mexico	30	4	13	36.50
New York	292	54	18	402.50
North Carolina	101	23	23	142.00
North Dakota	30	7	23	60.00
Ohio	315	50	16	382.00
Oklahoma	57	39	68	204.00

CONTRIBUTIONS BY GROUPS TO THE

1954 CONFERENCE FUND

<u>U.S.A.</u>	<u>No. of Groups</u>	<u>No. of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>% of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>Amt. of Contrib.</u>
Oregon	43	29	67%	\$ 145.00
Pennsylvania	178	48	27	315.00
Rhode Island	17	14	86	130.00
South Carolina	62	6	10	45.00
South Dakota	26	8	31	60.00
Tennessee	39	4	10	45.00
Texas	207	27	13	217.50
Utah	46	6	13	45.00
Vermont	19	6	32	40.00
Virginia	69	13	19	75.00
Washington	88	45	51	342.00
West Virginia	47	26	55	184.00
Wisconsin	116	26	22	150.00
Wyoming	19	5	26	35.00
U.S.A. Totals	4,159	1,044	25%	\$7,338.00
<u>C A N A D A</u>				
Alberta	31	8	26	55.00
British Columbia	88	47	53	435.00
Manitoba	23	4	17	25.00
New Brunswick	25	3	12	40.00
Newfoundland	4	-	-	-
Nova Scotia	37	5	14	50.00
Ontario	185	49	27	300.00
Prince Edward Island	4	-	-	-
Quebec	61	12	20	85.00
Saskatchewan	45	5	11	30.00
Yukon Territory	1	-	-	-
Canada Totals	504	133	26%	\$1,020.00
<u>OUTSIDE THE U.S.A. AND CANADA</u>	4	-	-	30.00
	4,667	1,177	25%	\$8,388.00

THE A. A. GRAPEVINE

Circulation vs. Reported A. A. Members - By States and Provinces

UNITED STATES

<u>State</u>	<u>Rept.</u> <u>AA Mem's*</u>	<u>Total</u> <u>GV Cir.</u>	<u>%</u>	<u>State</u>	<u>Rept.</u> <u>AA Mem's*</u>	<u>Total</u> <u>GV Cir.</u>	<u>%</u>
Alabama	1,136	223	19.6	Oregon	613	341	55.6
Arizona	560	199	35.5	Pennsylvania	3,150	1,246	39.6
Arkansas	857	303	35.4	Rhode Island	234	109	46.6
California	11,020	3,421	31.0	South Carolina	962	293	34.5
Colorado	911	312	34.2	South Dakota	560	178	31.8
Connecticut	1,103	384	34.8	Tennessee	633	186	29.4
Delaware	354	67	18.9	Texas	4,511	1,324	29.3
Dist. of Col.	543	238	43.8	Utah	1,040	221	21.3
Florida	2,309	772	33.5	Vermont	290	151	52.1
Georgia	970	290	29.9	Virginia	1,743	541	31.0
Idaho	395	160	41.0	Washington	1,533	587	38.3
Illinois	5,271	1,231	23.4	West Virginia	770	308	40.0
Indiana	1,702	624	36.5	Wisconsin	2,103	746	35.5
Iowa	1,689	580	34.3	Wyoming	159	65	40.8
Kansas	1,537	461	30.0	Totals			
Kentucky	773	224	29.0	of above	84,415	27,314	31.2
Louisiana	793	188	23.7				
Maine	694	246	35.4	<u>CANADA</u>			
Maryland	919	304	33.2	<u>Province</u>			
Massachusetts	2459	1,151	46.9	Alberta	512	187	36.5
Michigan	3,231	1,123	34.7	British Col.	1,453	401	27.6
Minnesota	1,634	784	48.0	Manitoba	510	202	39.6
Mississippi	713	276	38.7	New Brunswick	587	169	28.8
Missouri	2,184	558	25.6	Newfoundland	68	13	19.1
Montana	301	79	26.3	Nova Scotia	647	186	28.8
Nebraska	369	201	54.6	Ontario	2,764	1,044	37.8
Nevada	188	91	48.3	Pr. Edw. Is.	107	47	43.9
New Hampshire	248	134	56.3	Quebec	777	293	37.7
New Jersey	2,256	912	40.4	Saskatchewan	703	180	25.6
New Mexico	652	136	20.9	Yukon	7	1	14.3
New York	7,223	2,737	37.9	Totals			
N. Carolina	1,884	706	37.5	of above	8,134	2,723	33.5
N. Dakota	443	126	28.4				
Ohio	7,954	1,313	16.5	Percentage of Grapevine circulation			
Oklahoma	839	464	55.3	to reported A.A. membership			32.2%

* as shown in 1954 Directory

GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
ROSTER OF DELEGATES
1954

Abshire, F. W., First National Building, Tulsa, Oklahoma
Backus, August C., Fox Lane, Fox Point, Milwaukee, Wisconsin
Baldree, Aaron, 53 East Market Street, Bethlehem, Pennsylvania
Banville, William F., 805 Richmond Avenue, Silver Spring, Maryland
Barber, George, 54 Woodrow Avenue, Columbus 7, Ohio

- Black, R. D., Box 603, Palestine, Texas
Bowman, Don N., 630 Bellaire, Denver, Colorado
* Boyles, B. E., 3490 Woods Avenue, Lincoln, Nebraska
Brown, Walter, 617 5th Street, New Westminster, B. C., Canada
* Buchanan, Arthur W., 116 North Grove Street, East Aurora, New York
* Burwell, James M., 4193 Georgia Street, San Diego 3, California
Caldwell, Maurice, 181 Waterman Street, Providence 6, Rhode Island
Card, Emily, Chestnut Street, Ashland, Massachusetts
* Cardona, Tom, Box 788, Medford, Oregon
Chamberlain, Chuck, 316 South Elm Drive, Beverly Hills, California

- Clark, Fred, Box 97, North Webster, Indiana
Clarke, Warren O., 145 East Lee Avenue, Maplewood, Louisiana
* Crosland, E. H., 2910 $\frac{1}{2}$ Rosewood Drive, Columbia, South Carolina
* Davis, Harold P., North Shore Road, R.F.D. #2, Derry, New Hampshire
* DeWeese, Pete, A. DeWeese Lumber Company, Philadelphia, Mississippi

- Fautsch, Louis, 815 Roshek Building, Dubuque, Iowa
* Gilhuly, Ian K., Minnedosa, Manitoba, Canada
* Goode, Leon, 1601 Magnolia Avenue, Knoxville, Tennessee
* Grady, Maurice W., 1601 Bradley Street, Schenectady, New York
* Haben, Wendell, Box 461, Hibbing, Minnesota

- * Hanson, W. R., Box 85, Thermopolis, Wyoming
Haswell, Philip S., 1031 19th Street, Miami Beach, Florida
* Henry, Edward, 349 Garden Avenue, Camden, New Jersey
* Holton, Frank, Frankford, Delaware
Hughes, Rex, 1066 D Street, Provo, Utah

- Irvine, Wesley, 1523 Taylor Avenue, Bronx, New York
* Jacobs, J. C., Box 22, Moberly, Missouri
* Jamieson, H. S., Moosomin, Saskatchewan, Canada
* Kavanagh, John, 325 West 6th Street, Dixon, Illinois
* Kearney, Stan, 1335 Bernard Avenue West, Montreal, Quebec, Canada

- * Kelly, Charles B., Box 55, Aberdeen, South Dakota
Kerslake, Victor, 373 Benjamin, S.E., Grand Rapids, Michigan
* Lamb, Gilbert, Tahoka, Texas
* Layne, Frank H., 13 First Avenue, Prestonburg, Kentucky
Lunt, Arthur D., 200 McRae Drive, Toronto, Ontario, Canada

- * New Delegate

ROSTER OF DELEGATES
(Continued)

- MacGregor, Scott, Box 144, Staunton, Virginia
Macy, Ethel, Box 373, Route 1, Barberton, Ohio
* Maloney, Victor G., 2910 Calderwood Lane, Sacramento 21, California
* Marcy, Henry, 106 Alleghany Avenue, Baltimore 4, Maryland
* Meredith, A. R., 4115 Noyes Avenue, S.E., Charleston, West Virginia

* Mollo, Frank P., 12915 Trumbull Avenue, Highland Park 3, Michigan
* Moncrief, A. E., 608 Pecan Street, Albany, Georgia
Moore, Reginald H., Skyline Drive, Farmington, Connecticut
* Neufeld, Arnold, 235 Grover Street, Antigo, Wisconsin
* Newcomb, Charles, 403 North Monroe Street, Blissfield, Michigan

* O'Neil, Cy, Cut Bank, Montana
Penrose, Bud, 21 Farrington Place, Rochester, New York
* Perry, Walter, Colchester, Vermont
Peters, D. L., 617 West 84th Street, Seattle, Washington
* Phelps, Ira P., Box 1581, Corpus Christi, Texas

Posey, O.K., 136 Madrone Lane, No. 3, Larkspur, California
* Pratt, Lee, 1204 3rd Avenue South, Fargo, North Dakota
* Reddoch, Charles, Box 1573, Boise, Idaho
* Russell, John, Route #1, Great Bend, Kansas
Schadt, Fred, 17 South Crescent, Maplewood, New Jersey

Schif, Donald R., 426 West Orleans, Paxton, Illinois
* Schwarz, Mary Lu, 2315 Inez Drive, N.E., Albuquerque, New Mexico
* Shrubsall, A. J., 1725 24th Street West, Calgary, Alberta, Canada
* Smith, James A., 12 Brookline Avenue, Springfield, Massachusetts
Strickland, V. D., Box 26, Rich Square, North Carolina

Taylor, Bob, 116 Adams Street, Mankato, Minnesota
Trolan, Jack, Box 171, Gainesville, Florida
Turner, George, 7610 South Shore Drive, Chicago, Illinois
* Veigle, Charles H., Bethlehem Steel Company, Johnstown, Pennsylvania
* Wallace, Bruce, Box 102, Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada

Weatherford, Louis H., 1427 University Avenue, Tuscaloosa, Alabama
Weir, Tom, 205 East "F", Park Hill, North Little Rock, Arkansas
* Welch, Arthur D., 22 Monument Square, Portland, Maine
* Whitehead, Bert, Box 3236, Lowell, Arizona
Wright, Carl, Box 776, Dickinson, Texas

* New Delegate

TRUSTEES AND HEADQUARTERS STAFF1954

NON-ALCOHOLIC

Mr. Jack Alexander
1901 Walnut Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

Mr. Frank B. Amos
24 Smallwood Place
North White Plains, New York

Mr. Frank Gulden
50 Elizabeth Street
New York, New York

Mr. Leonard Harrison
105 East 22nd Street
New York 10, New York

Dr. John Norris
Medical Department
Eastman Kodak Company
Rochester, New York

Mr. Archibald Roosevelt
200 East 66th Street
New York, New York

Mr. Bernard B. Smith
551 Fifth Avenue
New York, New York

Dr. Leonard V. Strong, Jr.
133 East 58th Street
New York, New York

ALCOHOLIC

Adam Capeling
761 Bayview Avenue
Toronto, Ontario, Canada

J. Seegar Heavilin
48 Beach Street
Cedar Grove, New Jersey

Daniel J. Hennessy
270 Park Avenue
New York 17, New York

Sigurd Sandmore
180 Lyons Road
Scarsdale, New York

Earl Treat
2410 Marcy Avenue
Evanston, Illinois

Clifford Walker
1163 Ocean View
Whittier, California

Henry Zoeller
87-10 Clover Hill Road
Hollis, Long Island, New York

GENERAL SERVICE
HEADQUARTERS STAFF

Helen G. Brown
Henry F. Grieme
Eve Lum
Ann Macfarlane
Marian Mallet
Lib Symington

A. A. GRAPEVINE
STAFF

Sidney Allen
John A. Dunlop
J. Seegar Heavilin
Sigurd P. Sandmore
Louise Shonts
Katharine Swentzel
Sarah Thompson

COMMITTEES FOR THE 1954 CONFERENCE

Finance

Haswell, Fla.
Lunt, Ont.
Baldree, Pa.
Russell, Kan.
Goode, Tenn.
Newcomb, Mich.
(Lum - Sec.)

Literature

Banville, D. C.
Posey, Calif.
Taylor, Minn.
Buchanan, N. Y.
Burwell, Calif.
Boyles, Neb.
(Mallet - Sec.)

Agenda

Macy, Ohio
Chamberlain, Calif.
Schadt, N. J.
Maloney, Calif.
Neufeld, Wisc.
Welch, Me.
(Brown - Sec.)

Conference Report

Barber, Ohio
Brown, B. C.
Schif, Ill.
Trolan, Fla.
DeWeese, Miss.
O'Neil, Mont.
(Brown - Sec.)

Policy

Weir, Ark.
Abshire, Okla.
Backus, Wisc.
Lamb, Tex.
Layne, Ky.
Marcy, Md.
(Symington - Sec.)

Trustees

Jacobs, Mo.
Wright, Tex.
Kerslake, Mich.
Gilhuly, Man.
Haben, Minn.
Davis, N. H.
(Macfarlane - Sec.)

Conference Fund

Crossland, S. C.
Perry, Vt.
Neufeld, Wis.
Russell, Kan.
Moncrief, Ga.
Wallace, Maritimes
(Brown - Sec.)

A.A. Grapevine

Whitehead, Arizona
Wallace, Maritimes
Smith, Springfield, Mass.
Fred Clark, Ind.
Schif, Ill.
Caldwell, R. I.

1955 Convention

DeWeese, Miss.
Smith, Springfield, Mass.
O'Neil, Mont.
Phelps, Corpus Christi
Goode, Tenn.
Buchanan, Buffalo
Hanson, Wyo.
Sandmore (Trustee)
Roosevelt (Trustee)
Grieme (Headquarters)
Brown (Headquarters)